



halid pointed to a small potted plant on the windowsill, struggling toward the moonlight.

“Look at this plant,” he said. “It doesn’t grow in a perfectly straight line. It twists and bends, and sometimes it loses a leaf.”

But the struggle to reach for the light is the proof that it is alive. Your messy thoughts and mistakes aren’t signs of failure, Zayd. They are the growing pains of a living soul.”

Zayd looked at the plant again. It wasn’t perfect, but it was still trying.

Just like him.

He felt something shift inside—a tiny spark of hope, soft but real.